

When it comes to still image editing, it's nowhere near as powerful as Adobe Photoshop, but is still pretty good. You will only miss some of the advanced Photoshop editing capabilities here.

In audio editing, Premiere Elements is no match for even a semi-professional audio editor, but it still allows you to trim a clip, fade the audio in or out, cross-fade audio channels, record from the inputs on your computer, and mute specific audio clips. Overall, the audio editing is sufficient for most home and amateur video editors.

We couldn't seem to find the option to limit the video capture in terms of time or size, and a quick check online confirmed that Adobe seems to have forgotten to include this useful feature in Premiere Elements. This is a good option because a lot of us will not have too much free disk space, so, say, if you only have about 10 GB, this feature would have allowed you to specify exactly how much of raw video to capture from your camcorder!

Coming back to the interface, although there is a timeline view, there is no storyboard view, which is almost a must-have if you're making a movie from various clips. The storyboard view helps you organise your clips, so you can quickly call on them when needed, and also helps you plan out your video.

As a pure video editor, however, it offers all the expected options: splitting and trimming of clips, adding text into videos, adding audio tracks, the ability to change video aspect ratios and zooming in and out. You can also change frame rates, brightness, contrast, hue, and more.

Output files can be saved as MPEG-1 and 2, Windows Media and QuickTime. Real Media fans will be disappointed—it doesn't support that format.

Overall, Premiere Elements, like every other software here, offers all the tools a home user will ever need and more, but falls